

Communication skills

Credit Hours: 3-0

Course Outline

Introduction to Communication and Its Importance, Types and Levels of Communication, Verbal and Non-Verbal Communication, Elements and Process of Communication, Barriers to Effective Communication, Listening Skills and Active Listening, Oral Communication and Public Speaking, Presentation Skills, Group Discussion and Team Communication, Written Communication (Letters, Memos, Emails, Reports), Academic and Professional Writing, Reading and Comprehension Skills, Interpersonal Communication and Confidence Building, Cross-Cultural Communication, Communication in Professional and Academic Contexts, Interview Skills and Workplace Etiquette

16-Week Course Plan

Week 1

****Week 1: Introduction to Communication and Its Importance****

Lecture Title: Understanding Communication

Learning Objectives:

- Define communication and its importance
- Identify the types and levels of communication
- Recognize the significance of effective communication

Concepts:

Communication is the process of exchanging information, ideas, and messages between individuals or groups through a common system of symbols, signs, and behavior. Effective communication is crucial in personal, professional, and academic contexts. It involves the exchange of information, understanding, and feedback. There are two types of communication: verbal (spoken or written) and non-verbal (gestures, body language, tone of voice). Communication can occur at individual, group, or organizational levels.

****No Lab Hours this week.****

Week 2

****Week 2: Types and Levels of Communication****

Lecture Title: Types and Levels of Communication

Learning Objectives:

- Define different types of communication
- Identify various levels of communication

Concepts:

Communication can be categorized into several types based on the context, purpose, and method of communication. These types include:

- ****Intrapersonal Communication****: Communication within an individual, involving thoughts, feelings, and ideas.
- ****Interpersonal Communication****: Communication between two or more individuals, involving verbal and non-verbal cues.
- ****Group Communication****: Communication among three or more individuals, involving roles, norms, and dynamics.
- ****Mass Communication****: Communication to a large audience through various media channels.

- **Organizational Communication**: Communication within an organization, involving formal and informal channels.

Communication can also be classified into different levels, including:

- **Superficial Level**: Communication that focuses on surface-level issues and maintains social relationships.
- **Functional Level**: Communication that aims to achieve specific goals and tasks.
- **Personal Level**: Communication that involves self-disclosure, intimacy, and emotional connection.
- **Strategic Level**: Communication that involves long-term planning, goal-setting, and resource allocation.

Understanding the different types and levels of communication is essential for effective communication in various contexts.

Week 3

Week 3: Verbal and Non-Verbal Communication

Lecture Title: Verbal and Non-Verbal Communication

Learning Objectives:

- Define verbal and non-verbal communication
- Identify types of verbal communication
- Explain the importance of non-verbal communication
- Describe the relationship between verbal and non-verbal communication

Concepts:

Verbal communication refers to the exchange of information through spoken or written words. It is a crucial aspect of communication that conveys messages, thoughts, and ideas. Types of verbal communication include face-to-face conversation, phone calls, video conferencing, and written messages. Verbal communication can be formal or informal, depending on the context and purpose.

Non-verbal communication, on the other hand, involves the transmission of information through non-linguistic cues, such as body language, facial expressions, tone of voice, and physical proximity. Non-verbal communication can convey emotions, attitudes, and intentions, and is often used to reinforce or contradict verbal messages.

Effective communication requires a balance between verbal and non-verbal cues. Non-verbal communication can reinforce or contradict verbal messages, and can also convey emotions and attitudes. Understanding the role of non-verbal communication is essential to effective communication and relationships.

Lab:

No lab this week.

Week 4

****Week 4: Oral Communication and Public Speaking (3-0)****

Lecture Title: Effective Oral Communication and Public Speaking

Learning Objectives:

- Understand the importance of oral communication in personal and professional settings
- Identify key characteristics of effective public speakers
- Develop strategies for overcoming public speaking anxiety

Concepts:

Oral communication is a vital aspect of human interaction, conveying thoughts, ideas, and emotions through spoken words. Effective oral communication involves clarity, concision, and audience awareness. Public speaking is a crucial aspect of oral communication, requiring confidence, organization, and persuasive skills. To become an effective public speaker, one must develop strategies to manage nervousness, engage the audience, and convey a clear message.

****Key Characteristics of Effective Public Speakers:****

- Clear and concise language
- Confident body language
- Engaging tone and pitch
- Audience awareness and adaptation
- Preparation and organization

****Overcoming Public Speaking Anxiety:****

- Preparation is key
- Practice in front of a mirror or small group
- Focus on the message, not the self
- Use relaxation techniques, such as deep breathing or visualization
- Seek feedback and constructive criticism

Week 5

****Week 5: Group Discussion and Team Communication****

Lecture Title: Effective Group Discussion and Team Communication

Learning Objectives

- * Define group discussion and team communication
- * Identify key elements of effective group discussion

- * Explain the importance of team communication in a professional setting

Concepts

Group discussion and team communication are essential components of effective communication in a professional setting. A group discussion involves a collaborative exchange of ideas among team members to achieve a common goal. Effective group discussion requires active listening, clear articulation of ideas, and respectful feedback. Team communication involves the exchange of information, ideas, and opinions among team members to achieve a common objective. Key elements of effective team communication include clear communication, active listening, and conflict resolution.

In a group discussion, team members should:

- * Be prepared and informed
- * Listen actively and respectfully
- * Articulate their ideas clearly and concisely
- * Encourage open and honest feedback
- * Resolve conflicts in a constructive manner

Effective team communication leads to better collaboration, increased productivity, and improved decision-making. In a professional setting, team communication is crucial for achieving organizational goals and objectives.

Week 6

****Week 6: Group Discussion and Team Communication****

Lecture Title: Effective Team Communication in Group Discussion

Learning Objectives:

- Understand the importance of group discussion and team communication.
- Identify key factors that contribute to effective team communication.
- Learn strategies for facilitating group discussion and team collaboration.

Concepts:

Group discussion and team communication are essential components of effective communication in various contexts. In a team setting, communication is critical to achieve collective goals. Effective team communication involves active listening, clear expression of ideas, and respect for diverse perspectives. Key factors that contribute to effective team communication include clear goals, open-mindedness, and a willingness to collaborate.

In a group discussion, team members should engage in active listening, ask open-ended questions, and build on each other's ideas. Strategies for facilitating group discussion include using non-verbal cues, encouraging participation, and summarizing key points. To foster a collaborative environment, team members should be aware of their communication style, cultural differences, and potential biases.

Key Takeaways:

- * Effective team communication is critical for achieving collective goals.
- * Active listening, clear expression of ideas, and respect for diverse perspectives are essential in team communication.
- * Key factors that contribute to effective team communication include clear goals, open-mindedness, and a willingness to collaborate.
- * Strategies for facilitating group discussion include using non-verbal cues, encouraging participation, and summarizing key points.

Week 7

****Week 7: Group Discussion and Team Communication****

Lecture Title: Effective Group Discussion and Team Communication**Learning Objectives:**

- Understand the importance of group discussion and team communication in various contexts
- Identify the key elements of effective group discussion and team communication
- Analyze the role of active listening and conflict resolution in group communication

Concepts:

Group discussion and team communication are essential in various contexts, including business, education, and personal relationships. Effective group discussion and team communication involve active listening, clear expression of ideas, and respectful feedback. Key elements of effective group discussion and team communication include:

- ****Clear goals and objectives****: Establishing a shared understanding of the discussion's purpose and outcomes
- ****Active listening****: Paying attention to others, asking clarifying questions, and paraphrasing to ensure understanding
- ****Respectful feedback****: Providing constructive feedback that encourages participation and growth
- ****Conflict resolution****: Managing disagreements and finding mutually beneficial solutions
- ****Roles and responsibilities****: Assigning clear roles and responsibilities to team members to ensure a smooth workflow

Effective group discussion and team communication foster collaboration, creativity, and problem-solving. By understanding these key elements, individuals can improve their communication skills and contribute to successful team outcomes.

Week 8

****Week 8: Academic and Professional Writing****

Lecture Title: Effective Writing in Academic and Professional Contexts

Learning Objectives

- Define the importance of effective writing in academic and professional contexts
- Identify the key characteristics of academic and professional writing
- Understand the differences between formal and informal writing styles

Concepts

Effective writing is a crucial aspect of communication in both academic and professional contexts. Academic writing is used to convey knowledge, ideas, and research findings in a clear and concise manner. Professional writing, on the other hand, is used to communicate with colleagues, clients, and stakeholders in a workplace setting. Key characteristics of academic writing include objectivity, clarity, and precision. In contrast, professional writing often requires a more formal tone and attention to audience and purpose.

In academic writing, authors must use proper citation and referencing to avoid plagiarism and give credit to original sources. In professional writing, the tone is often more formal, and the language is more concise. Understanding the differences between formal and informal writing styles is essential for effective communication in both contexts.

Week 9

****Week 9: Communication in Professional and Academic Contexts****

Lecture Title: Communication in Professional and Academic Contexts

Learning Objectives:

- Understand the importance of communication in professional and academic contexts
- Identify key differences between professional and academic communication
- Analyze the role of communication in achieving career goals and academic success

Concepts:

Communication is a critical skill in both professional and academic contexts. In a professional setting, effective communication enables employees to convey information, negotiate, and build relationships with colleagues, clients, and customers. In an academic setting, effective communication is essential for students to succeed in their studies, participate in class discussions, and complete assignments.

Professional communication often involves clear, concise, and formal language, while academic communication may involve more technical and specialized vocabulary. Understanding the nuances of communication in these contexts is crucial for achieving career goals and academic success.

Effective communication in professional and academic contexts requires awareness of the audience, purpose, and tone of the message. It also involves active listening, clear articulation of ideas, and adaptability to different communication styles. By developing strong communication skills, individuals can build trust, establish credibility, and achieve their goals in both professional and academic settings.

Week 10

****Week 10: Cross-Cultural Communication****

Lecture Title: Effective Cross-Cultural Communication Strategies

Learning Objectives:

- Define cross-cultural communication
- Identify key factors influencing cross-cultural communication
- Apply effective strategies for cross-cultural communication

Concepts:

Cross-cultural communication refers to the exchange of information between individuals from different cultural backgrounds. Key factors influencing cross-cultural communication include power dynamics, cultural values, and language differences. Effective strategies for cross-cultural communication include:

- * Active listening and asking open-ended questions
- * Avoiding cultural stereotypes and assumptions
- * Using non-verbal communication effectively (e.g., avoiding direct eye contact in some cultures)
- * Being aware of power dynamics and adapting language and tone accordingly
- * Using clear and concise language

Key Takeaways:

- * Cross-cultural communication requires awareness of cultural differences and adaptability.
- * Effective cross-cultural communication involves active listening, avoiding stereotypes, and using non-verbal communication effectively.

Week 11

****Week 11: Oral Communication and Public Speaking****

Lecture Title: Effective Oral Communication and Public Speaking

Learning Objectives

- Understand the importance of oral communication in personal and professional settings
- Identify the key elements of public speaking
- Develop skills to engage an audience effectively

Concepts

Oral communication is a vital aspect of human interaction, conveying messages, ideas, and perspectives through spoken words. Public speaking is a subset of oral communication, where an individual conveys information to a group of people. Effective oral communication involves clarity,

concision, and persuasive delivery. Key elements of public speaking include preparation, organization, tone, and body language. To engage an audience, speakers must establish credibility, use storytelling techniques, and vary their tone and pitch. Practice and feedback are essential for improving public speaking skills.

****Key Takeaways:**** Effective oral communication is critical in personal and professional settings; public speaking involves preparation, organization, tone, and body language; practice and feedback enhance public speaking skills.

Week 12

****Week 12: Interview Skills and Workplace Etiquette (2-0)****

Lecture Title: Effective Interviewing and Professional Etiquette

Learning Objectives:

- Understand the importance of interview skills in professional settings
- Learn the key elements of effective interviewing
- Develop awareness of workplace etiquette and its impact on professional relationships

Concepts:

Interviews are a crucial aspect of professional communication, influencing career advancement and networking opportunities. Effective interviewing requires preparation, active listening, and clear articulation of thoughts and experiences. Key elements include:

- Researching the organization and position
- Preparing thoughtful questions and responses
- Demonstrating enthusiasm and confidence
- Showing interest in the company's mission and values

Workplace etiquette encompasses various aspects, including:

- Dress code and personal appearance
- Communication style and tone
- Respect for colleagues and superiors
- Use of technology and digital communication tools

Understanding and practicing these skills will enhance professional interactions and contribute to a positive work environment.

Week 13

****Week 13: Interview Skills and Workplace Etiquette (3-0)****

Lecture Title: Mastering Interview Skills and Workplace Etiquette

Learning Objectives:

- Understand the importance of effective interview skills
- Learn the key elements of a professional interview
- Recognize the significance of workplace etiquette in professional settings

Concepts:

Effective interview skills are crucial for both job seekers and professionals in the workplace. A well-prepared interview demonstrates a candidate's confidence, enthusiasm, and commitment to the organization. Key elements of a professional interview include:

- Researching the company and position
- Preparing thoughtful questions
- Using positive body language and tone
- Demonstrating relevant skills and experiences
- Following up with a thank-you note or email

Workplace etiquette is equally important, encompassing behaviors such as:

- Respectful communication with colleagues and supervisors
- Adhering to dress code and grooming standards
- Using technology responsibly and professionally
- Maintaining a positive and inclusive work environment

By mastering interview skills and practicing good workplace etiquette, individuals can enhance their professional image and contribute to a positive and productive work environment.

Week 14

****Week 14: Effective Communication in the Workplace and Presentation Skills (3-0)****

Lecture Title

Effective Communication in the Workplace and Presentation Skills

Learning Objectives

- * Identify the importance of effective communication in the workplace
- * Understand the key elements of effective presentation skills
- * Develop strategies for delivering persuasive presentations

Concepts

Effective communication is crucial in the workplace, enabling employees to convey ideas, negotiate, and resolve conflicts. It involves verbal and non-verbal cues, active listening, and clear articulation of thoughts. In this lecture, we will focus on presentation skills, which are essential for conveying information, persuading others, and building relationships.

****Key elements of effective presentation skills:****

- * Clear and concise message
- * Confident body language
- * Engaging tone and pitch
- * Visual aids and multimedia
- * Audience awareness and adaptation

****Strategies for delivering persuasive presentations:****

- * Know your audience and tailor your message
- * Use storytelling techniques to engage your audience
- * Practice your delivery to build confidence
- * Use visual aids to support your message
- * Encourage audience participation and feedback.

Week 15

****Week 15: Effective Communication in the Workplace and Career Development****

Lecture Title: Effective Communication in the Workplace and Career Development

Learning Objectives:

- Identify the importance of effective communication in workplace settings
- Describe the role of communication in career development and advancement
- Explain the significance of networking and professional relationships in the workplace

Concepts:

Effective communication is crucial in the workplace as it fosters a positive work environment, improves productivity, and enhances career development. In this context, communication involves not only exchanging information but also building relationships and networking. Effective communication in the workplace can lead to career advancement opportunities, promotions, and increased job satisfaction.

A strong professional network can provide valuable support, mentorship, and opportunities for growth. Developing effective communication skills, such as active listening, clear expression, and conflict resolution, is essential for building and maintaining professional relationships. In addition, networking and professional relationships can lead to job opportunities, recommendations, and valuable industry connections.

To develop effective communication skills in the workplace, individuals should focus on building strong relationships with colleagues, supervisors, and clients. This can be achieved by being approachable, willing to listen, and providing value to others. By doing so, individuals can establish themselves as reliable, trustworthy, and valuable team members, leading to career advancement and personal growth.

Week 16

****Week 16: Academic and Professional Writing****

Lecture Title: Effective Academic and Professional Writing

Learning Objectives

- Define the characteristics of academic and professional writing
- Identify the key elements of effective academic and professional writing
- Analyze the importance of tone, style, and format in academic and professional writing

Concepts

Academic and professional writing are essential skills for effective communication in various contexts. Academic writing involves writing research papers, essays, and reports for educational purposes, while professional writing includes business reports, proposals, and emails. Effective academic and professional writing requires clarity, accuracy, and attention to detail.

Key elements of effective writing include:

- Clear purpose and audience identification
- Logical organization and structure
- Use of proper grammar, spelling, and punctuation
- Tone and style that is formal and objective
- Adherence to specific format and conventions (e.g., APA, MLA, Chicago)

Understanding the tone, style, and format required for academic and professional writing is crucial for effective communication and presentation. This lecture will focus on the characteristics, key elements, and importance of academic and professional writing.